

Get [Outlook for Mac](#)

From: onboarding@resend.dev <onboarding@resend.dev>

Date: Friday, 1 May 2026 at 1:09 pm

To: Nicholas, Rhett <rhett.nicholas@accenture.com>

Subject: [External] Your Daily Digest – May 01, 2026

WARNING: External email. Be vigilant with links, attachments, and requests.

DAILY BRIEFING

May 01, 2026

DAILY BUSINESS BRIEFING

Your 10-Minute Read

For Australian business operators · Full digest below

AI & Technology

Anthropic is closing in on a funding round that could value the company at over \$900 billion — and it could land within two weeks. That would make it one of the most valuable private companies on earth. Legal AI startup Legora hit a \$5.6 billion valuation this week, deepening its battle with rival Harvey for dominance in law firms. The AI arms race is accelerating and the money is following it.

Google is putting its Gemini assistant into millions of cars, claiming real estate in the dashboard. Stripe extended its Link digital wallet so AI agents can make purchases autonomously — a quiet but significant move toward AI that shops on your behalf. Apple was caught off guard by AI-driven Mac demand and is scrambling to keep up. Meta's business AI is now running 10 million conversations per week.

Elon Musk took the stand to testify that xAI trained its Grok model on OpenAI data — explosive testimony that could reshape the ongoing legal

fight between the two companies. OpenAI, meanwhile, restricted access to its Cyber security model weeks after publicly criticising Anthropic for limiting its own Mythos model.

Australian Business & Finance

Queensland Rail workers are set to halt hundreds of services from May 5 in an escalating pay dispute. The action will hit commuters and freight operators hard heading into winter. At the same time, government assistance for the Nyrstar smelter sites in Port Pirie and Hobart ended today, putting hundreds of manufacturing jobs in immediate doubt. If Nyrstar cannot find a new funding arrangement fast, those jobs go.

The NT ambulance service is being described as on the brink of collapse. Its CEO has raised the alarm in stark terms — a serious warning for a Territory already stretched by rising demand and workforce shortages. The NDIS integrity boss also told a parliamentary hearing that funding leakage was a foreseeable problem that should have been addressed before rollout began.

World Markets & Global Business

Oil prices hit their highest point since 2022 after reports emerged that Donald Trump is preparing to be briefed on new military options against Iran. Markets moved sharply on the news, with traders pricing in fresh Middle East supply risk. Trump also signed a bill ending the record-long US government shutdown, removing a major source of economic uncertainty that had hung over markets for weeks.

China scrapped tariffs on imports from almost every African nation in a sweeping trade move designed to deepen its economic foothold across the continent. In the Americas, the first direct commercial flight between the US and Venezuela since 2019 touched down, signalling a cautious diplomatic thaw between two countries that have been at loggerheads for years.

The Big Picture

The Palantir controversy is intensifying in Australia. Calls are growing to ban the US data firm from government contracts after its corporate manifesto was described by a UK MP as the "ramblings of a supervillain."

That debate sits at the intersection of AI governance, national security, and who ultimately controls public data — a question Australian policymakers can no longer ignore.

Alice Springs is also in the spotlight after unrest erupted following the arrest of a man over the murder of young Kumanjayi Little Baby. The violence exposed deep social fractures that remain unresolved in remote Australia. Both stories point to the same pressure: government institutions are being tested, and the gap between policy and reality is widening.

Full stories across AI, Australia, and the world are below.

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

AI Overview

Anthropic is on the verge of a funding round that could push its valuation past \$900 billion, while legal AI startup Legora hit \$5.6 billion as the AI investment boom shows no signs of slowing. Google, Stripe, and Meta all made significant moves to embed AI deeper into everyday infrastructure — cars, payments, and business chat.

1. TECHCRUNCH

Business

Sources: Anthropic potential \$900B+ valuation round could happen within 2 weeks

Anthropic is reportedly closing in on a new funding round that would value the AI safety company at over \$900 billion, potentially making it one of the most valuable private companies in history. Sources say the deal could be finalised within two weeks.

2. TECHCRUNCH

Business

Legal AI startup Legora hits \$5.6B valuation and its battle with Harvey just got hotter

Legora has reached a \$5.6 billion valuation, cementing its position as a major player in the rapidly consolidating legal AI market. The milestone intensifies its rivalry with Harvey as both companies compete for contracts with top law firms.

3. TECHCRUNCH

Lab Announcement

Google's Gemini AI assistant is hitting the road in millions of vehicles

Google is rolling out its Gemini AI assistant to millions of vehicles, extending its AI platform into the automotive space. The move puts Gemini in direct competition with other in-car AI systems as automakers race to integrate conversational AI into dashboards.

4. TECHCRUNCH

Industry News

Stripe introduces Link, a digital wallet that autonomous AI agents can use, too

Stripe has expanded its Link digital wallet to support autonomous AI agents, enabling them to complete purchases without human input. The move signals a shift toward agentic commerce where AI systems transact independently on behalf of users and businesses.

5. TECHCRUNCH

Industry News

Elon Musk testifies that xAI trained Grok on OpenAI models

Elon Musk testified in court that his AI company xAI used OpenAI models to train its Grok chatbot, a significant admission in the ongoing legal dispute between the two organisations. The testimony could have major implications for how courts treat AI training data and intellectual property.



PODCAST PICKS

The TWIML AI Podcast (formerly This Week in Machine Learning & Artificial Intelligence) How to Engineer AI Inference Systems with Philip Kiely - #766

Philip Kiely breaks down the engineering decisions behind building AI inference systems at scale, covering latency, throughput, and cost trade-offs. A practical episode for anyone running or evaluating AI infrastructure in production.

 WORLD NEWS
Global Snapshot

Oil prices surged to their highest point since 2022 after reports that Donald Trump is preparing to be briefed on new military options against Iran, rattling global energy markets.

1. BBC NEWS

Oil price hits highest since 2022 after report Trump to be briefed on new Iran options

Oil prices jumped to their highest level since 2022 after a report that Donald Trump will be briefed on new military options targeting Iran, stoking fears of supply disruption in the Middle East. Traders moved quickly to price in the geopolitical risk, sending energy markets sharply higher.

2. BBC NEWS

Trump signs bill to end record shutdown over immigration enforcement

Donald Trump has signed legislation ending the longest government shutdown in US history, which had been triggered by a standoff over immigration enforcement funding. The resolution removes a prolonged source of economic uncertainty that had disrupted federal services and rattled investor confidence.

3. BBC NEWS

China scraps tariffs for all but one African nation

China has eliminated import tariffs on goods from almost every African nation in a sweeping trade policy shift designed to strengthen its economic and diplomatic ties across the continent. The move comes as Western nations grapple with their own trade policy turmoil, giving Beijing a significant soft-power opportunity.

 AUSTRALIAN NEWS
Australia Snapshot

Unrest erupted in Alice Springs after police arrested Jefferson Lewis over the murder of young Kumanjayi Little Baby, with community leaders calling for

calm amid ongoing tensions.

1. THE GUARDIAN

Unrest in Alice Springs after Jefferson Lewis arrested over death of Kumanjayi Little Baby

Violence broke out in Alice Springs following the arrest of a man over the death of Kumanjayi Little Baby, prompting community elders and the girl's grandfather to publicly call for calm. The incident has reignited debate about social conditions and public safety in remote Northern Territory communities.

2. ABC NEWS (JUST IN)

Poliovirus detected in Perth wastewater

Health authorities have detected poliovirus in Perth's wastewater system, raising public health concerns in Western Australia. Officials are urging residents to check their vaccination status as authorities work to determine the source and extent of the detection.

3. ABC NEWS (JUST IN)

Hundreds of Queensland Rail services to be halted amid pay dispute

Queensland Rail workers are set to suspend hundreds of train services from May 5 as an industrial dispute over pay escalates, with major disruption expected for commuters and freight across the state. Businesses relying on rail freight should begin contingency planning immediately ahead of the action.

Generated by RacingHQ · Powered by AI